Imperial College London

Christian Postgraduate Group

SESSION 1 · 8 OCTOBER 2026

Intro to IFES

Field → Christ & Christ → Field

18:15 – 19:30 | Thursday 8th October 2026



Tafara Makuni
Leader



Nancy Chen
Co-Leader

Term 1 Session Overview

Term 1 Session Dates:

- Fri 2nd October 2026: Freshers Welcome: *Introductions & Testimonies*. *Location: Senior Common Room (SCR), South Kensington Campus.*
- Thu 8th October 2026: Session 1: *Intro to IFES: Field-Christ & Vice-Versa. *Location: Senior Common Room (SCR), South Kensington Campus.*
- Fri 16th October 2026, 18:30, **Dr Tafara Makuni**: 'Should Christian Scientists Fear AI?'. **Location: Christ Church Kensington, London W8 5RQ.**
- Thu 5th November 2026: Session 2: *How our Fields Point to Christ & Vice-Versa. *Location: Senior Common Room (SCR), South Kensington Campus.*
- Fri 20th November 2026, 18:30, **Dr Edmund Michaelson**: 'All-In: Your Christian Career Guide - Fruitful Work'. **Location: Christ Church Kensington, London W8 5RQ.**
- Thu 26th November 2026: Session 3: *How our Fields Point to Christ & Vice-Versa.*Location: Senior Common Room (SCR), South Kensington Campus.*
- Thu 10th December 2026: End-of-Term Celebration *Praise and Worship. *Location: Senior Common Room (SCR), South Kensington Campus.*

Term 1 Session Overview

Session 1 — Thu 8th Oct: ***Intro to IFES: Field–Christ & Vice-Versa***

- Introduction to IFES and the Good News for the University vision
- The **two-directional framework** (From Christ → Field; From Field → Christ)
- The **Three Foundations** from the GAP Core Values
- Small group discussion questions to help members connect faith and their discipline
- Signposting to UCCF Research Network and Forming a Christian Mind

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Fri 16th October 2026, 18:30
Speaker: Dr Tafara Makuni: 'Should Christian Scientists Fear AI?'.
Location: Christ Church Kensington, London W8 5RQ.

Session 2 — Thu 5th Nov: ***How Our Fields Point to Christ & Vice-Versa***

- A structured walkthrough of the **GAP "7 Distinctions"** framework (Creation, Fall, Redemption, Scripture, Creation's Witness, Apologetics, Local Opportunity)
- Consider putting some slides together based on your research/field.
- Signposting to the **Fellows Programme** and GAP study guides

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Fri 20th November 2026, 18:30
Dr Edmund Michaelson: 'All-In: Your Christian Career Guide - Fruitful Work'.
Location: Christ Church Kensington, London W8 5RQ.

Session 3 — Thu 26th Nov: ***Fields & Christ Part 2 + Apologetics***

- Discussion of slides and how that could fit on a poster.
- Teaching on **apologetics through our disciplines** — three practical models (Order, Ethics, Meaning)
- A **term vision-cast** to close the term with purpose

Term 1 Session 1

- Welcome & Opening Prayer
- What is IFES?
- The Two-Directional Vision
- Field Specific Discussion
- Group Discussion & Next Steps
- Prayer Points (Subject Relevant)

Session Aim

To introduce members to IFES and the Good News for the University vision, and to begin exploring the two-directional relationship between our academic fields and the gospel of Christ.

Core Vision

"Jesus Christ is good news for the university:
both for its scholars and for their research."

— IFES / Good News for the University

Christ → Our Field

Lordship · Scripture · Faithful Scholarship
Working excellently for God's glory

⇄

Our Field → Christ

Creation's order · Beauty · Complexity
Pointing others to the Creator

IFES EUROPE Good News for the University

Home Values Get involved Resources About



Meeting together locally across Europe, **students are supporting one another** in our shared calling as young academics.

What is IFES?

Global Movement

IFES (International Fellowship of Evangelical Students) operates in 180+ countries, helping students share and live out the good news of Jesus Christ — locally, nationally, globally.

UK Expression

GB

In the UK, IFES works through UCCF (Universities and Colleges Christian Fellowship). UCCF Research is the postgraduate arm, partnering with Forming a Christian Mind & Good News for the University.

ICPG's Place

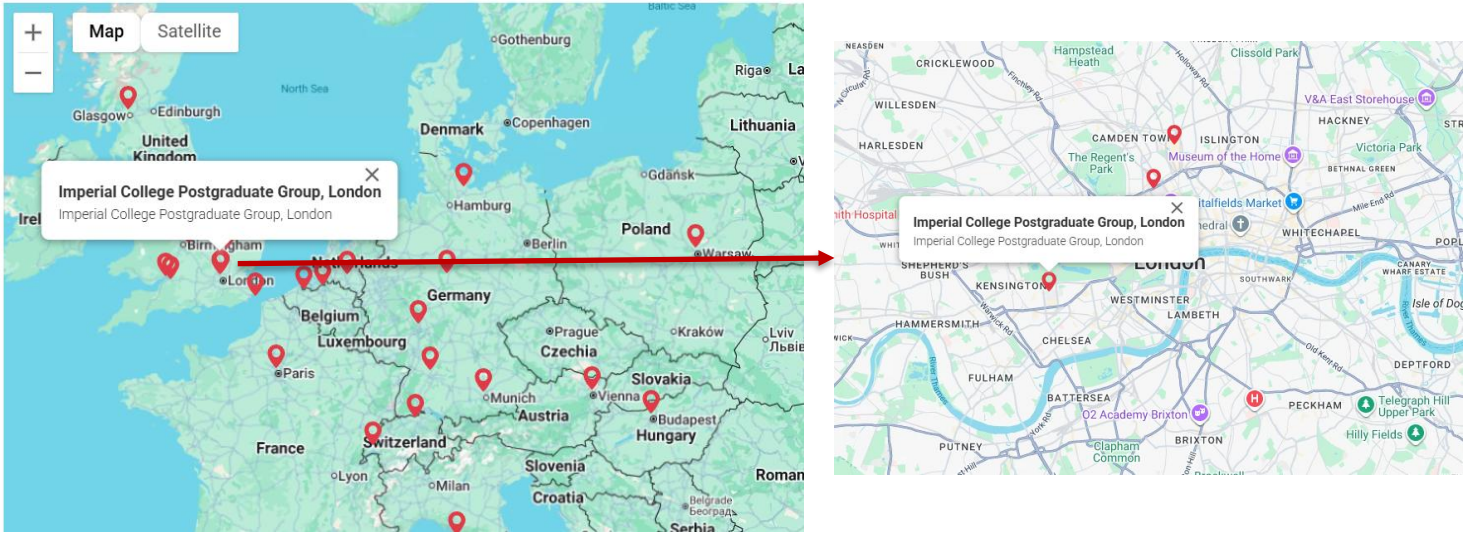
ICPG is part of the Association of Christian Postgraduate Groups — a network of self-led groups across Europe united around a shared mission and common values.

The Goal

Everything IFES does is aimed at helping postgrads grow in ability to contribute to studies in the light of Scripture and make use of opportunities to point others to Christ.

What is IFES?

Association Groups



Three Foundations (GAP Core Values)



Three Foundations (GAP Core Values)

1

Common Mission

The gospel shapes our research, and our research helps us point to the gospel. Christ is Lord of all fields — science, medicine, engineering, humanities.

2

Common Beliefs

Rooted in Scripture as 'true truth' for all academic disciplines. The Bible speaks into our research, not just our private lives.

3

Common Ethos

We serve the university excellently as Christians, not despite being Christians. Integrity, excellence, and care for colleagues are forms of witness.

"Everything we do is aimed at helping you grow in your ability to contribute to your studies in the light of Scripture, and make use of opportunities you have in your field to point others to Christ."

Specific Field Discussion

Q1

Introduce yourself

What is your field of study or research? What drew you to it?

Q2

Christ → Your Field

How does your faith shape the way you approach your research? (e.g. motivations, ethics, how you treat colleagues, what questions you ask)

Q3

Your Field → Christ

Is there anything in your discipline that seems to point toward God — his creativity, order, complexity, or care for humanity?

Q4

Challenge

Where do you find it hardest to connect your faith and your academic work? What questions do you still have?

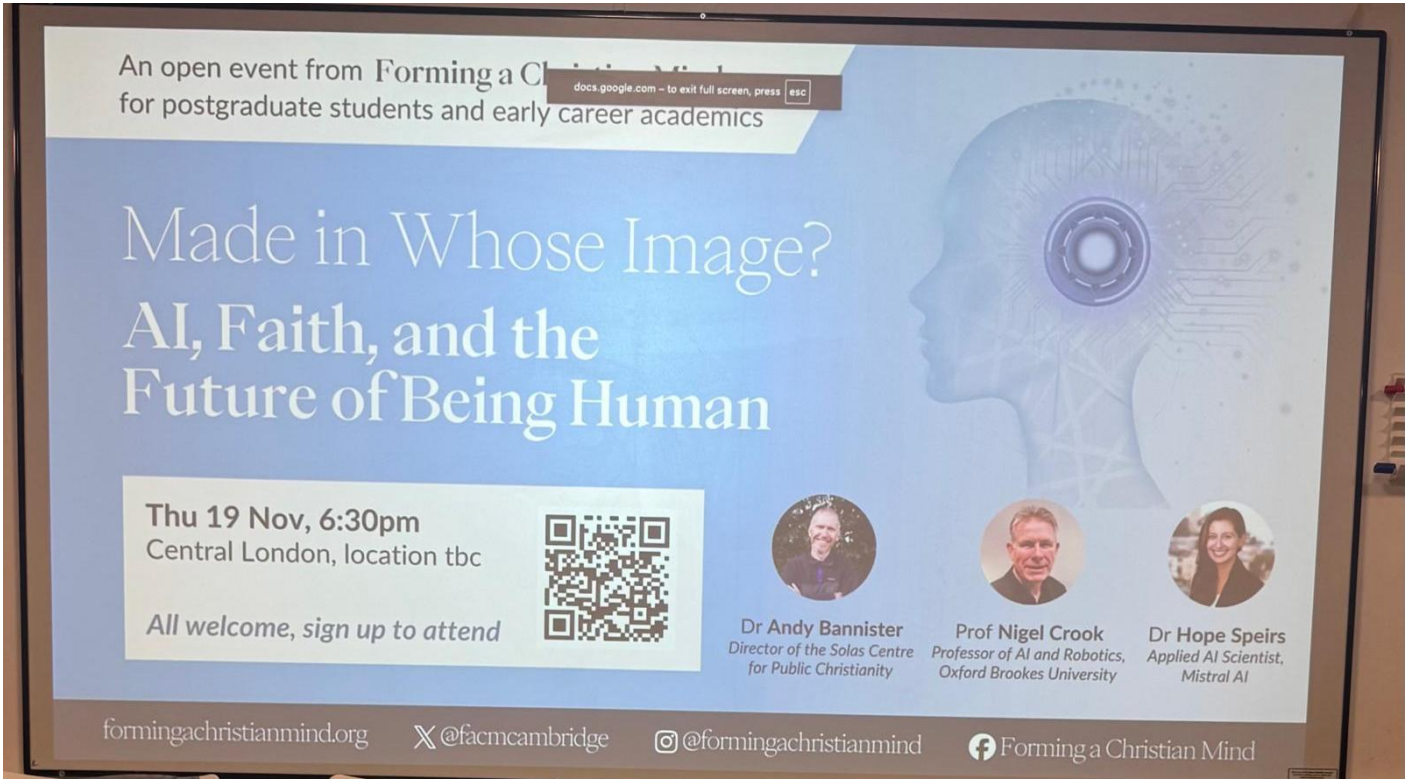
Group Discussion

"Notice how across our different fields — medicine, engineering, AI, global health — we're all finding the same thing: that Christ is not an add-on to our work but the foundation of it."

Signposting & Next Steps

Next Session — Fri 16th Oct:	**Dr Tafara Makuni: 'Should Christian Scientists Fear AI?'**
Session 2 — Thu 5th Nov:	How our Fields Point to Christ & Vice-Versa · SCR
UCCF Research Network:	uccf.org.uk/research/apply — monthly resources & event invites
Good News for the University:	goodnewsfortheuniversity.org
Forming a Christian Mind:	formingachristianmind.org — London seminars for Christian postgrads


The Gospel and Academia Project
Fellows Programme
Join a community of postgraduate students exploring how to relate the Christian faith to academic work, across a 22-week series of guided readings, talks and discussion.
An annual programme running
November 2026 - June 2027
Register now
for Taster Sessions
Beginning 24 Nov


An open event from Forming a C
for postgraduate students and early career academics
docs.google.com – to exit full screen, press esc
Made in Whose Image?
AI, Faith, and the Future of Being Human
Thu 19 Nov, 6:30pm
Central London, location tbc
All welcome, sign up to attend
Dr Andy Bannister
Director of the Solas Centre for Public Christianity
Prof Nigel Crook
Professor of AI and Robotics, Oxford Brookes University
Dr Hope Speirs
Applied AI Scientist, Mistral AI
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Forming a Christian Mind Spring Conference 2027
Minds, Machines and the Maker
(Re)Making the Human in a Digital Age
Saturday 6 March | Cambridge
Keynote Speaker
Prof Simeon Zahl
Professor of Christian Theology, University of Cambridge